

## NES cartridge for \$5,000

An extremely rare NES cartridge was spotted on eBay containing the rare Nintendo World Championships game.

## Windows 8.1 update 1

According to reports and leaked screenshots, the next update to Windows will be arriving by March in the form of Windows 8.1 update 1.



No computing powerhouses these, but even so, budget laptops are the workhorses that keep this world running. Here are nine worthy contenders for your hard-earned cash.

Anirudh Regidi  
anirudbregidi@thinkdigit.com

**T**he budget laptop is the Ford Model T of the PC. The device that'll bring the joy and power of computing to

the masses in a functional and appropriately powerful form factor and suitable price. We've come a long way from the truly horrific netbooks that made up the budget category of yesterday, laptops that ruined the reputation of portable com-

puting the world over. Though tablets have helped.

The budget laptops that we received this time around are far more powerful, far more usable and definitely something that everyone would want, even if it's just something to carry as

a backup device. Everything's received a significant upgrade, Windows 8.1 is supposed to be much lighter on resources, the CPUs are far more powerful and also more efficient at the same time. We've also seen the resurgence of AMD with their E1 and A-series APUs, not to mention vast improvements to Intel's Celeron CPUs. Something else that we were pleasantly surprised to see was the presence of touchscreens in this segment. Not an essential feature mind you, but it's novel and Windows 8.1 is definitely more fun, and functional, with a touchscreen.

What we don't yet see in the budget segment are the latest processors and of course, SSDs. That said, all the laptops were well-built and the Achilles heels of earlier budget laptops, lack of power and awful displays, is something that seems to have been completely eliminated.

The horrible netbooks that we mentioned earlier were horrible not because of what they represented, which was cheap computing, but the fact that they were so badly implemented. The budget offerings this time around are sensibly designed and definitely feel like a more mature and appealing segment to us.

Without any further ado, here are the contenders.

### Lenovo S210 Touch

Lenovo is known for its great ergonomics and the S210 Touch is yet another example of their skill. The laptop is tiny, but it's powerful and incorporates what we feel is the best touch-pad in the 11-inch form factor; it's a pitfall that many manufacturers still haven't learned to avoid. The device is well-built, has a solid hinge and hosts a very decent and responsive touchscreen. The design of the battery